

Stop believing these lies about losing fat.

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 18, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/FnBfznk4UVA> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter rapid-fires answers to five fat-loss myths, clarifying that sweat, light weights, soreness, spot reduction, and fat burners are all misunderstood — and that diet control is the only guaranteed lever.

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Myth 1: Sweating Means You're Burning Fat [0:00](#)

- **Sweating has nothing to do with burning fat**
 - Sweat is simply your body's cooling mechanism — it regulates temperature, nothing more
 - Fat does not exit the body through sweat glands
- You can get shredded even if you barely sweat during workouts

Myth 2: Light Weights Are Fine When Cutting [0:07](#)

- Using only light weights while cutting is, in Carter's words, "a big mistake"
- You should still lift heavy even in a caloric deficit
 - Heavy lifting signals the body to retain muscle mass
 - Without that signal, you risk losing muscle and ending up looking "skinny" rather than lean and athletic
- The "toning" myth unpacked:
 - Many women gravitate toward light weights because they want to "tone" — but Carter says there is no such thing as toning a muscle
 - Being toned simply means being muscular with low body fat simultaneously
 - The muscle must be built and preserved; low weight training does not achieve that
- Takeaway: keep pushing yourself hard in the gym regardless of whether you are in a cut

Myth 3: Soreness Proves Your Workout Worked 0:21

- You can absolutely get shredded without being sore after every session
 - Carter notes he personally has not been sore in roughly 10 years
- Soreness is not evidence that a workout was effective
 - It is only evidence that your body was not accustomed to that movement or volume — i.e., you haven't been training consistently enough
- Do not use soreness (or its absence) as a measure of training quality

Myth 4: You Can Spot-Reduce Fat 0:31

- Training a specific body part does **not** cause fat loss in that area
 - Fat is lost systemically ("accumulatively") across the whole body, not in isolated spots
- Carter uses a blunt example aimed at women who want to lose fat but preserve curves:
 - "If you lost your curves when you lost fat, ladies, that ass wasn't as big as you thought it was."
 - The implication: if glutes or chest appear to shrink significantly with fat loss, they were largely composed of fat rather than muscle to begin with
- The fix is building actual muscle in desired areas while reducing overall body fat

Myth 5: Fat Burners Can Replace Diet Control 0:43

- Fat burners are useless if your diet is not in order — nothing replaces controlling what you eat
- **Tracking calories and macros is the only thing guaranteed to work**
- Extreme example offered: Carter has seen people using steroids who still look out of shape because they refuse to track their calories and macros
 - If even anabolic steroids can't overcome a poor, untracked diet, no supplement can